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Electric lighting systems with removably couplable power devices

Abstract

An example electric lighting system includes a lighting device that includes a housing including a lighting element and a power device holding portion. The power device holding portion includes a cavity. The cavity includes a first and a second electrical contact disposed within the cavity. The power device includes a third and a fourth electrical contact. The power device includes a coupling component. The coupling component is removably couplable to the power device holding portion such that an electrical communication is established when the power device is inserted into the cavity at any rotational position relative to the lighting device about a shared central axis. The power device is operable to power the lighting device through the electrical communication. The electrical communication is established between the first electrical contact and the third electrical contact and between the second electrical contact and the fourth electrical contact.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application is a continuation of U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 17/654,977, filed Mar. 15, 2022, which is a continuation of U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 17/125,450, filed Dec. 17, 2020, the contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference in the entirety fully set forth below.

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) The present disclosure relates to electric lighting systems that have lighting elements such as LEDs and removably couplable power devices.

Description of Related Art

(2) Current electrical lights require plugging-in, insertion of a battery, connecting wires, or unscrewing components. Connecting wires to a battery or unscrewing components to insert a battery is a time-consuming and unpleasant experience for a user. Lights that need plugging-in also lack the aesthetic and freedom of movement and requires unsightly wiring. These problems are exacerbated when there are numerous lights to maintain. For example, a hotel or a restaurant may require one or more lights for numerous rooms or dining tables. Also, plug-in options would require electrical connections for each table. If a restaurant includes a cordless light at every table, it may take employees significant time to individually plug in each light for charging. If a restaurant includes a light with a cord, the cord may diminish the aesthetic of a cord-free table. Additionally, users that may want to change the appearance of a light may need to purchase an entirely new light, including its power device, instead of just the light itself. Finally, users may want to charge a power device for a light while the light is in use without plugging in the light during use.

SUMMARY

(3) Disclosed herein are electric lighting systems that overcome the limitations of earlier systems. In some embodiments, electric lighting systems allow for easy recharging and replacement, saving time for users. These electric lighting systems may save additional time for a user such as an employee of a hotel or restaurant that set a charged light in every room or at every table each night. Some example electric lighting system embodiments allow for quick and easy insertion and removal of a power device into a lighting element. Some example electric lighting systems have removably couplable power devices such that the power device can be charged while another power device is in use with a lighting element. Such functionality allows a user to, for example, provide a light for a guest at a table in a restaurant, while charging another power device. The removably couplable functionality overcomes disadvantages of other systems which would require a user to purchase two lights for continuous use, since the power device cannot be removed to be charged.

(4) Some example electric lighting systems may include any one or more of the following elements. Some example electric lighting systems include a lighting device. The lighting device may include a housing that includes a lighting element and a power device holding portion. The power device holding portion may include a cavity. The cavity may include a first electrical contact disposed within the cavity and a second electrical contact disposed within the cavity. The power device may include a third electrical contact and a fourth electrical contact. The power device may include a coupling component. The coupling component may be removably couplable to the power device holding portion such that an electrical communication is established when the power device is inserted into the cavity at any rotational position relative to the lighting device about a shared central axis. The power device may be operable to power the lighting device through the electrical communication. The electrical communication may be established between the first electrical contact and the third electrical contact and between the second electrical contact and the fourth electrical contact.

(5) In some example electric lighting systems, the third electrical contact may be operable to engage the first electrical contact at any rotational position of the power device relative to the lighting device about the shared central axis. The fourth electrical contact may be operable to engage the second electrical contact at any rotational position of the power device relative to the lighting device about the shared central axis.

(6) In some example electric lighting systems, the first electrical contact may encircle the second electrical contact and the third electrical contact may encircle the fourth electrical contact.

(7) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device holding portion may include a lighting device magnet disposed within the cavity. The coupling component may include a power device magnet positioned to engage with the lighting device magnet.

(8) In some example electric lighting systems, the lighting device magnet and the power device

magnet may be configured such that the power device is self-orienting with respect to the lighting device.

- (9) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device holding portion may include a plurality of lighting device magnets within the cavity. The power device may include a plurality of power device magnets positioned to engage with the plurality of lighting device magnets.
- (10) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device may provide a base for the lighting device when the coupling component is removably coupled to the lighting device such that the lighting device is operable to stand upright on the power device.
- (11) In some example electric lighting systems, the electric lighting system may include a charger removably couplable to a bottom portion of the power device. The charger may provide a base for the power device when the charger is removably coupled to the power device such that the power device is operable to stand upright on the charger.
- (12) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device may include a controller operable to adjust the brightness of the lighting element.
- (13) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device may include a controller. The lighting element may include an array of light emitting diodes (LEDs). The controller may be operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs.
- (14) In some example electric lighting systems, the lighting device may include a controller operable to adjust the brightness of the lighting element.
- (15) Some example electric lighting systems may include a plurality of lighting devices. The plurality of lighting devices may include a first lighting device having a first shape. The first lighting device may include a first housing including a first lighting element and a first power device holding portion. The first power device holding portion may include a first universally sized and shaped cavity. The plurality of lighting devices may include a second lighting device having a second shape. The second lighting device may include a second housing including a second lighting element and a second power device holding portion. The second power device holding portion may include a second universally sized and shaped cavity. The electric lighting system may include a universally sized and shaped power device comprising a coupling component. The coupling component may be removably couplable to the first power device holding portion such that a first electrical communication is established when the power device is inserted into the first universally sized and shaped cavity at any rotational position relative to the first lighting device about a first shared central axis. The coupling component may be removably couplable to the second power device holding portion such that a second electrical communication is established when the power device is inserted into the second universally sized and shaped cavity at any rotational position relative to the second lighting device about a second shared central axis.
- (16) In some example electric lighting systems, the first power device holding portion may include a first lighting device magnet disposed within the first universally sized and shaped cavity. The second power device holding portion may include a second lighting device magnet disposed within the second universally sized and shaped cavity. The coupling component may include a power device magnet positioned to engage with the first lighting device magnet and the second lighting device magnet.
- (17) In some example electric lighting systems, the first lighting device may be a downward projecting illuminator including a first lighting element and a top portion. The first lighting element may be mounted within the top portion. The second lighting device may be an upward projecting illuminator including a second lighting element and a bottom portion. The second lighting element may be mounted within the bottom portion.
- (18) In some example electric lighting systems, the power device may provide a base for the first lighting device when the coupling component is removably coupled to the first lighting device such that the first lighting device is operable to stand upright on the power device. The power device may provide a base for the second lighting device when the coupling component is removably

coupled to the second lighting device such that the second lighting device is operable to stand upright on the power device.

(19) In some example electric lighting systems, the first lighting device may include a first electrical contact. The second lighting device may include a second electrical contact. The power device may include a third electrical contact. The third electrical contact may be operable to engage the first electrical contact at any rotational position of the power device relative to the first lighting device about a shared central axis of the first lighting device and the power device. The third electrical contact may be operable to engage the second electrical contact at any rotational position of the power device relative to the first lighting device about a shared central axis of the first lighting device and the power device.

(20) In some example electric lighting systems, the electric lighting system may include a charger removably couplable to a bottom portion of the power device. The charger may charge the power device. The charger may provide a base for the power device when the charger is removably coupled to the power device such that the power device is operable to stand upright on the charger.

(21) In some example electric lighting systems, the first lighting element may be operable to receive electrical power from the power device through electrical communication with the power device. The second lighting device may be operable to receive electrical power from the power device through electrical communication with the power device. The power device may include a controller. The controller may be operable to adjust the brightness of the first lighting element and the second lighting element.

(22) In some example electric lighting systems, the first lighting element may include an array of light emitting diodes (LEDs). The controller may be operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs.

(23) In some example electric lighting systems, the first lighting device may include a first lighting element and a first controller. The first controller may be operable to adjust the brightness of the lighting element.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWING(S)

(1) FIG. 1 is an exploded view of an example electric lighting system in accordance with some embodiments.

(2) FIG. 2 is a bottom isometric view of an example lighting device in accordance with some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 3 is a top isometric view of an example power device in accordance with some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 4 is an isometric view of an example electric lighting system in a removably coupled state in accordance with some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 5 is an isometric view of an example electric lighting system in a removably coupled state with a charger in accordance with some embodiments.

(6) FIG. 6 is a bottom view of an example lighting device in accordance with some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 7 is a top view of an example power device in accordance with some embodiments.

(8) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an example electric lighting system in accordance with some embodiments.

(9) FIG. 9 is an exploded view of an example electric lighting system that includes a plurality of lighting devices in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Users of lighting device may desire to use a lighting device without plugging the lighting device into a wall. For example, a restaurant may desire to place a lighting device on patrons'

tables, without laying wires across the floor or the table. Additionally, lighting devices may benefit from the aesthetic of having no wire and practical benefit of not impeding limited space, such as at a restaurant table. Use of such mobile lighting devices may present challenges for powering the lighting devices.

(11) Without receiving power directly from an electrical outlet of a wall, lighting devices may therefore include mobile power devices that retain charge to power the light without the need for plugging in to the wall while the lighting device is turned on. The lighting device will be able to turn on if it receives sufficient power from the power device. Eventually, the power device will transfer enough energy to the lighting device that it becomes depleted and cannot provide enough power to the lighting device. A user may ultimately need to charge a power device such that it may once again power the lighting device. But recharging the power device will require another source of electric power, such as an electrical outlet.

(12) Recharging a power device takes time and effort and can reduce portability. A user may interchange a power device connected to the lighting device, move the lighting device or power device to a location where it may be charged, or otherwise direct power (for example, by extension cord) to the location of the lighting device. The recharging effort is increased when there are numerous lighting devices to be used. An employee of a hotel, for example, may need to recharge hundreds of power devices so that the power devices and lighting devices can be used again for each hotel room. Additionally, a user may want to keep a lighting device in continuous use, such that the lighting device may remain at its intended point of use, such as a restaurant table, lobby space, meeting room, or hotel room.

(13) Some electric lighting systems disclosed herein include the ability to easily and timely connect a power device to a lighting device without having to manually align the power device, connect wires, or unscrew components to insert batteries. Some electric lighting systems also provide utility where the power device is connected in such a manner that the end user experience (such as a restaurant patron) is unimpeded by the sight of a bulky power device. Some electric lighting systems provide the ability to disconnect a depleted removably couplable power device for charging and insert a removably charged power device, so that the lighting device may be continuously used without need for moving or connecting the lighting device itself to a charger. Such continuous use may also decrease expenses for a user who may otherwise have purchased multiple chargeable lighting devices, so that end users (such as hotel guests) could always have a light in use. Some electric lighting systems also provide universal interconnectivity, thereby providing the ability to interchange a power device for one type of lighting device for another lighting device.

(14) FIG. 1 depicts an example electric lighting system **100** in accordance with some embodiments. The electric lighting system **100** includes a lighting device **102** and a power device **104**. The power device **104** may include any type of battery, including any type of rechargeable battery. The lighting device **102** includes a housing **106** including a lighting element **108** and a power device holding portion **110**. The housing **106** includes structure to retain components such as the lighting element **108** and may be made of any material such as a plastic or metal. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. 1, the lighting element **108** can be disposed within the housing **106**. The power device holding portion **110** is configured to electrically communicate with the power device **104** so that the power device **104** may supply power to the lighting device **102** and ultimately illuminate the lighting element **108**. The lighting device **102** includes a cavity **112**. The cavity **112** and the power device **104** include electrical contacts sufficient to engage such that an electrical communication is established (as further described in the example shown in FIGS. 2 and 3).

(15) The lighting element **108** can include any one or more of an incandescent bulb, a light-emitting diode (LED), a liquid crystal display (LCD), and any other lighting technology. For example, the lighting element **108** may include an array of LEDs (or other lighting technology). An array includes two or more lights in any arrangement. The lighting element **108** may be configured

to mimic flames. For example, one or more LEDs may be varied over time in response to a controller to simulate a flickering or wind effect of a flame. The lighting device **102** could take any suitable three-dimensional shape, such cylinder, or cube, and may include translucent material, semi-translucent material, opaque material, or a combination thereof to create different lighting effects.

(16) One benefit of the electric lighting system **100** is that the power device **104** may be easily decoupled and recoupled to the lighting device **102**. When the power device **104** is depleted of power, a user may simply and easily decouple the power device **104** and charge the power device **104** separately from the lighting device **102**. Concurrently, a user may couple a second power device to the lighting device **102**. And when the second power device is depleted, the user may decouple and charge the second power device and recouple the now charged first power device **104**. This ability to removably couple the power device **104** may provide the user with the ability to continuously use a lighting device without the need to ever plug in the lighting device **102** itself.

(17) To aid in decoupling and recoupling, the power device holding portion **110** is configured to hold the power device **104**. The power device holding portion **110** may include a cavity **112**. The cavity **112** is operable to receive the power device **104** by insertion. The power device **104** may be partially or fully inserted into the cavity **112**.

(18) To further aid in decoupling and recoupling, the power device **104** includes a coupling component **122**. In the embodiment shown in FIG. **1**, the coupling component **122** includes power device magnets **124a** and **124b**, each positioned to engage with any of lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** of the power device holding portion **110**. The power device magnets **124a** and **124b** can be disposed under the surface of the power device **104**. The lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** are disposed under a surface within the cavity **112**. These magnets provided are embodiment of an easily couplable system, but other easily coupled components can be used, such as mating grooves and ridges, clamps, keyed prongs, screws, or any other easily removable coupling mechanism.

(19) To further describe advantages of the electric lighting system **100**, a shared central axis **128** is depicted in FIG. **1** and serves as a point of reference in a three-dimensional x-y-z coordinate plane. The shared central axis **128** extends in the z-direction in FIG. **1**, but the shared central axis could be oriented in any direction. For example, the power device **104** and the lighting device **102** could share a central axis in the x-direction, wherein the lighting device **102** couples to the power device **104** from the side in the x-direction. Rotation about the shared central axis **128** occurs when one or both of the lighting device **102** and the power device **104** turn about the central axis **128** in the x-y plane.

(20) One benefit of an embodiment of the electric lighting system **100** is self-orientation. In the embodiment including power device magnets **124a** and **124b**, magnetic force may be sufficient to cause self-orientation at any degree of rotation about the shared central axis **128** of the lighting device **102** and the power device **104**. Alternatively, magnetic force may cause self-orientation only at some degrees of rotation about the central shared axis **128**. For example, if a user inserts the power device **104** into the lighting device **102** and each of the power device magnets **124a** and **124b** are rotationally in-between the lighting device magnets **126a** through **126b**, the magnetic force may be too weak to cause rotation. Accordingly, the user may rotate the lighting device **102** with respect to the power device **104** such that the power device magnets **124a** through **124b** and lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** are within sufficient proximity to cause magnetic force to further rotate the lighting device **102** and/or magnetically align the lighting device **102** into place. The self-orientation of the power device **104** may also be referred to as self-orientation of the lighting device **102**, as either is being oriented with respect to the other. The self-orienting feature aids in allowing a user to insert the power device **104** into the cavity **112** at any rotational position to establish an electrical connection between the power device **104** and the lighting device **102**. Accordingly, in this embodiment the lighting device **102** and power device **104** do not require a

particular orientation to be operational. The magnets **124a**, **124b**, **126a**, and **126b** may rotate the power device **104** or the lighting device **102**, or the user may rotate the power device **104** or the lighting device **102**, or both, and the magnets **124a**, **124b**, **126a**, and **126b** orient the power device **104** into an aligned position with the lighting device **102**. At such an aligned position, electrical communication can be established and the power device **104** can power the lighting device **102**. Therefore, the power device **104** can power the lighting device when inserted into the cavity **112** at any rotational position

(21) Self-orientation may allow a user to easily couple and decouple the power device **104** from the lighting device **102**. For example, the self-orientation of the electric lighting system **100** allows the user to couple the electric lighting system **100** as follows. The user may first set the power device **104** on a surface. Next, the user simply inserts the power device **104** into the cavity **112** by lowering the lighting device **102** onto the power device **104**. One benefit of the self-orientating design is that the user need not worry about the degree of rotation of the lighting device **103** compared to the power device **104**. The user may simply rotate the lighting device **103** until the power device magnets **124a** and **124b** and the lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** attract. Any one of the power device magnets **124a** and **124b** can attract to any one of the lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b**. Therefore, the user need not align any one magnet to another and can freely releasably couple the lighting device **102** to the power device **104**, saving the user's time and effort and enhancing the user experience. When the user is ready to decouple the lighting device **102** from the power device **104**, the user may simply rotate the lighting device **102** to distance the lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** from the power device magnets **124a** and **124d**. The user may then lift the lighting device **102** from the power device **104**.

(22) The electric lighting system **100** also allows for easy carrying. When the power device **104** is coupled to the lighting device **102**, the user may lift the lighting device **102**, and the force between the power device holding portion **110** and the coupling component **122** may be sufficient to prevent the power device **104** from decoupling while being transported.

(23) Embodiments of the electric lighting system **100** can have features that aid in establishment of electrical communication with insertion at any rotational position. First, the electric lighting system **100** has the self-orienting feature as described above. Second, the electric lighting system has encircling electrical contacts, as shown in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3.

(24) FIG. 2 depicts a bottom isometric view of the lighting device **102**, showing the power device holding portion **110** of the housing **106**. The cavity **112** of the housing **106** includes a first electrical contact **114** disposed within a cavity **112** and a second electrical contact **116** disposed within the cavity **112**. The first electrical contact **114** can encircle the second electrical contact **116**. This embodiment allows reliable electrical connection independent of orientation.

(25) FIG. 3 depicts a top isometric view of the power device **104**, showing the power device holding portion **110**, including a third electrical contact **118** and a fourth electrical contact **120**. The third electrical contact **118** encircles the fourth electrical contact **120**. The first electrical contact **114** and second electrical contact **116** of FIG. 2 are operable to engage with the third electrical contact **118** and fourth electrical contact **120** of FIG. 3. When the first electrical contact **114** engages with the third electrical contact **118** and when the second electrical contact **116** engages with the fourth electrical contact **120** such that electrical current can flow, an electrical communication is established.

(26) In some embodiments, either one of the self-orienting or encircling features may be sufficient to establish electrical communication at any rotational position. For example, if the electric lighting system did not have encircling electrical contacts, the self-orienting feature could be sufficient to align electrical contacts of any other shape or suitable configuration (e.g., points, lines, rectangles, protrusions and holes, grooves and ridges). Without the encircling electric contacts, the user could insert the lighting device **102** into the cavity **112** with electrical contacts of the lighting device **102** misaligned with electrical contacts of the power device **104**. Then, during or after insertion of the

power device **104** into the lighting device **102**, the self-orienting feature causes alignment of the power device magnets **124a** and **124b** with the lighting device magnets **126a** and **126b** and rotates and/or magnetically connects the power device **104**. Such rotating and/or magnetically connection causes alignment of power device electrical contacts **118** and **120** and lighting device electrical contacts **114** and **116**. Additionally, the encircling feature (wherein the first electrical contact **114** encircles the second electrical contact **116** and the third electrical contact **118** encircles the fourth electrical contact **120**) may be sufficient to establish electrical communication at any rotational position as the first and second electrical contact **114** and **116** can engage the third and fourth electrical contact **118** and **120** at any point due to their circular shape.

(27) FIG. **4** depicts the example electric lighting system **100** in a releasably coupled state resting on a surface. As shown in FIG. **4**, the power device **104** is included in housing **106** that provides a base for the lighting device **102** when the coupling component is removably coupled to the lighting device such that the lighting device **102** is operable to stand upright on housing **106**, which includes the power device **104**. The power device **104** serving as a base for the lighting device **102** provides ease of coupling, allowing the user to releasably couple the lighting device **102** to the power device **104** while the power device **104** is resting on a surface. Alternative, the electric lighting system **100** could be configured with a power device **104** that stands atop a lighting device **102**. The electric lighting system **100** could be configured with a power device that attaches at the side or from any other angle.

(28) FIG. **5** depicts the electric lighting system **100** with a charger **502**. The charger **502** is removably couplable to a bottom portion **504** of the power device **104**. The charger **502** provides a base for the power device **104** when the charger **502** is removably coupled to the power device such that the power device **504** is operable to stand upright on the charger **530**. As a base for the power device **104**, the charger permits easy connectivity by setting the power device **104** on top of the charger **502**.

(29) FIGS. **6** and **7** depict an alternative embodiment of a lighting device **600** and a power device **700** in accordance with some embodiments and provides a view of how the power device **700** may releasably couple to the lighting device **600**. In FIG. **6**, the lighting device **600** includes a power device holding portion **602**. The power device holding portion **602** includes lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d** and within a cavity **606**. The power device holding portion includes a first electrical contact **608** and a second electrical contact **610** disposed within the cavity **606**.

(30) FIG. **7** depicts a power device **700** including a coupling component **702**. The coupling component **702** includes power device magnets **704a** through **704d** positioned to engage with the plurality of lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d** shown in FIG. **6**. For example, when a user holds the lighting device **600** in place and inserts the power device **700** into the cavity **606**, the magnetic force between the power device magnets **704a** through **704d** and the lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d** may be sufficient to rotate the power device **700**. The power device **700** may be rotated such that each of the power device magnets **704a** through **704d** are aligned with the lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d**. If the power device **602** is resting in place on a surface and the user inserts the lighting device **600** into the cavity **606** by placing the lighting device **600** over the power device **700** and lowering the lighting device **600**, the magnetic force between the power device magnets **704a** through **704d** and the lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d** respectively, may be sufficient to rotate the lighting device **600**. The lighting device **600** may be rotated such that each of the power device magnets **704a** through **704d** are aligned with each of the lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d**. The power device **700** includes a third electrical contact **706** and a fourth electrical contact **708**. This self-orienting feature is sufficient to establish electrical communication between the first electrical contact **608** and the third electrical contact **706** and between the second electrical contact **610** and the fourth electrical contact **708** at any rotational position about a shared central axis.

(31) Numerous variations to the power device holding portion **602** and the coupling component

702 of FIGS. **6** and **7** may be made. For example, the lighting device magnets **604a** through **604d** are disposed within the cavity **606** but could be placed on another location of the power device holding portion **602**. While shown with magnets **704a** through **704d**, the coupling component **702** and the power device holding portion **602** may have different or additional coupling mechanisms, including for example, mating grooves and ridges, screws, or any other coupling mechanism. The coupling component **702** and the power device holding portion **602** may also use any number of magnets, instead of or in addition to those shown. The coupling component **702** may also have more or fewer magnets than the respective number of magnets in the power device holding portion **702**.

(32) In some electric lighting systems, the electric lighting system can be configured to provide different lighting effects, such as flame simulation or intensity or brightness of lighting. FIG. **8** is a block diagram of an example electric lighting system **800**. The electric lighting system **800** includes a lighting device **802** and a power device **804**. The lighting device **802** includes a lighting element **806**. The lighting element **806** includes an array of light emitting diodes **808a** through **808d**. The lighting element **806** includes a controller **810** that is operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs **808a** through **808d** through electrical communication. For example, the controller **810** can increase the intensity of LED **808a** while decreasing the intensity of LED **808b**. The power device **804** includes a controller **812** operable to adjust the brightness of the lighting element **806**, including the ability to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs **808a** through **808d**. The controller **812** is operable to communicate with the controller **810** and both or either may to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs **808a** through **808d**. Independent adjustment of brightness occurs when one or more LEDs is adjusted while one or more LEDs is adjusted differently or not adjusted. While the electric lighting system has a controller **810** and a controller **812**, some electric lighting systems may have only one controller, no controller, or additional controllers.

(33) Another advantage of some electric lighting systems disclosed herein is universal interconnectivity. These systems provide the ability to interchange a power device for one type of lighting device for another lighting device and allowing a user to have multiple types of lighting devices without the need for purchasing a power device for each lighting element.

(34) FIG. **9** depicts an example electric lighting system **900** that includes a plurality of lighting devices including a first lighting device **902** and a second lighting device **904**. The first lighting device **902** has a first shape that is different from a second shape of the second lighting device **904**. The first lighting device **902** is a downward projecting illuminator including a top portion **906** and a first lighting element **908**. The second lighting device **904** is an upward projecting illuminator including a second lighting element **909** and a bottom portion **910**. The second lighting element **909** is mounted within the bottom portion **910**.

(35) One advantage of the electric lighting system **900** is that it provides universal connectivity such that the first lighting device **902** and the second lighting device **904** can be interchangeably used and powered by the same source. The first lighting device **902** includes a first housing **912** including the first lighting element **908** and a first power device holding portion **916**. The first lighting element **908** is mounted within the top portion **906**. The first power device holding portion **916** includes a first universally sized and shaped cavity **918**. The second lighting device **904** includes a second housing **920** including the second lighting element **909** and a second power device holding portion **924**. The second power device holding portion **924** includes a second universally sized and shaped cavity **926**. The electric lighting system **900** includes a universally sized and shaped power device **928** including a coupling component **930**. The universal sizing of the cavity **918**, the cavity **926**, and the power device **928** allows for universal connectivity, such that a user can use the same power device **928** for different lighting devices **902** and **904**.

(36) The electric lighting system **900** may also provide advantages described in FIGS. **1-8**, such as self-orientation and removable coupling. For example, the coupling component **930** is removably

couplable to the first power device holding portion **916** such that a first electrical communication is established when the power device **928** is inserted into the first universally sized and shaped cavity **918** at any rotational position relative to the first lighting device **902** about a first central axis **932**. When the power device **928** is aligned with the first central axis **932**, the first central axis **932** is shared between the power device **928** and the first lighting device **902**. The coupling component **930** is removably couplable to the second power device holding portion **924** such that a second electrical communication is established when the power device **928** is inserted into the second universally sized and shaped cavity **926** at any rotational position relative to the second lighting device **904** about a second central axis **934**. When the power device **928** is aligned with the second central axis **934**, the second central axis **934** is shared between the power device **928** and the second lighting device **904**.

(37) The electric lighting system **900** uses magnetic force to removably couple the power device **928** to the first lighting device **902** and the second lighting device **904**. The first power device holding portion **916** includes a first lighting device magnet **936** disposed within the first universally sized and shaped cavity **918**. The second power device holding portion **924** includes a second lighting device magnet **938** disposed within the second universally sized and shaped cavity **926**. The coupling component **930** includes a power device magnet **940** positioned to engage with the first lighting device magnet **936** and the second lighting device magnet **938**. While the electric lighting system **900** uses magnetic force to removably couple, it may use any other coupling mechanism(s) as described above in discussion of other figures.

(38) It may be desirable for the power device **928** provide a base for multiple lighting elements, despite their different shapes. The power device **928** may provide a base for the first lighting device **902** when the coupling component **930** is removably coupled to the first lighting device **902** such that the first lighting device **902** is operable to stand upright on the power device **928**. The power device **928** may provide a base for the second lighting device **904** when the coupling component **930** is removably coupled to the second lighting device **904** such that the second lighting device **904** is operable to stand upright on the power device **928**. By being able to couple to the downward projecting first lighting device **902** and the downward projecting second lighting device **904**, the electric lighting system **100** provides a power device **928** operable to both (1) removably couple to both upward and downward projecting illuminators at any rotational position about a shared central axis and (2) provide a base for both upward and downward projecting illuminators. Being universally sized and shaped, the power device **928** could also couple to differently shaped upward, downward, or other directionally projecting illuminators. Additionally, as described above in reference to earlier example power devices, the power device **928** may have electrical contacts operable to connect to electrical contacts of the first lighting device **902** and to electrical contacts of the second lighting device **904** at any rotational position about a first central axis **932** when shared with the power device **928** and a second central axis **934** when shared with the power device **928**, respectively.

(39) The electric lighting system **900** may include a charger as described in reference to earlier figures. The electric lighting system **900** may also power the lighting devices **902** and **904** with the power device **928** as described for other electric lighting systems. The electrical device may include one or more controllers as described in reference to earlier figures. The one or more controllers may be located in one or more of a first lighting device **902**, the second lighting device **904**, the power device **928**, and may be operable to control the first lighting element **908**, the second lighting element **909**, or both. The first lighting element **908** and the second lighting element **909** may include one or more arrays of light emitting diodes (LEDs). One or more controller(s) may be operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs.

(40) The above description is illustrative, and the electric systems described herein are not limited to any one embodiment. One or more aspects of any one or more figures may be combined with,

substituted, or removed from any other one or more figures. Additionally, other modifications may be made to the systems disclosed herein without departing from the novelty of the disclosure.

Claims

1. An electric lighting system comprising: a plurality of lighting devices comprising: a first lighting device having a first shape, the first lighting device comprising a first housing including a first lighting element and a first power device holding portion, the first power device holding portion comprising a first universally sized and shaped cavity and a first lighting device magnet disposed within the first universally sized and shaped cavity; a first universally sized and shaped power device comprising a coupling component, wherein: the first universally sized and shaped power device is operable to be inserted into the first universally sized and shaped cavity of the first lighting device such that only a bottom portion of the first universally sized and shaped power device is visible once it is coupled to the first lighting device; and a charger removably couplable to a bottom portion of the first universally sized and shaped power device, wherein: the charger charges the first universally sized and shaped power device; and the charger provides a base for the first universally sized and shaped power device when the charger is removably coupled to the first universally sized and shaped power device such that first universally sized and shaped the power device is operable to stand upright on the charger.
 2. The electric lighting system of claim 1, wherein: the first power device comprises a power device controller; and the power device controller is operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs.
 3. The electric lighting system of claim 2, wherein the power device controller can communicate with the lighting device controller to adjust the brightness of light emanating from the lighting element.
 4. The electric lighting system of claim 2, wherein power device controller can control the power provided to the first lighting device.
 5. The electric lighting system of claim 1, further comprising a second universally sized and shaped power device, wherein upon depletion of the power in the first universally sized and shaped power device, the first universally sized and shaped power device can be uncoupled from the first lighting device and the second universally sized and shaped power device can be coupled to the first lighting device.
 6. The electric lighting system of claim 5, wherein the first universally sized and shaped power device can be connected to a charger while the second universally sized and shaped power device can be coupled to the first lighting device.
 7. The electric lighting system of claim 1, the coupling component further comprising a power device magnet positioned to engage with the lighting device magnet.
 8. The electric lighting system of claim 1, wherein the coupling component is removably couplable to the first universally sized and shaped power device holding portion such that a first electrical communication is established when the first universally sized and shaped power device is inserted into the first universally sized and shaped cavity.
 9. The electric lighting system of claim 1, wherein the coupling component further comprises a first power device magnet positioned to engage with the lighting device magnet.
 10. The electric lighting system of claim 1, wherein: the first lighting device comprises a lighting device controller; the first lighting element comprises an array of light emitting diodes (LEDs); and the lighting device controller is operable to independently adjust the brightness of each of the array of LEDs.
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